Project Report

CSE0001 – Digital Literacy

Name	**Shreya Adhikary**
Registration Number	**25BCE11282**
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Introduction

This project is part of the CSE0001 Digital Literacy course at VIT Bhopal University. As part of this assignment, I took on the role of a Student Digital Ambassador, someone responsible for helping peers navigate the digital world safely and professionally. Over the course of five tasks, I created a digital literacy infographic, set up professional online profiles, explored coding and collaboration platforms, practised professional email writing, and researched cybercrime awareness. All work has been organized and submitted through a single GitHub repository. This project gave me hands-on experience with tools and platforms that are directly relevant to my academic and professional journey as a computer science student.

Task 1
Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic

Tool I Used

In this task I have created a single page infographic using Canva, a free browser based design tool.

I chose canva because it provides us with ready made templates that not only makes it easy to arrange content visually without any prior design experience but also saves a lot of time for students.

What my design shows

My infographic titled “Digital Literacy for Students” covers four key topics:

- ☐ What digital literacy means
- ☐ Safe internet practices
- ☐ Building a professional digital identity
- ☐ Professional email etiquette

For each topic I kept the text short and added relevant icons to make the information easy to read at a glance and interesting. The overall design uses a dark blue theme which gives it a clean and modern look.

Challenges faced

The most challenging part of the project was fitting all the four topics in a single page without making it look too crowded. I had to shorten each point and rely on icons and spacing to make the layout breathable.

What i found interesting in this project

What I found interesting was how much thought goes into visual communication. The same information feels completely different depending on how it is arranged on a page. This task made me realize that digital literacy is not just about using tools, but also about presenting information clearly and responsibly to others.

Task 2
Build Your Student Digital Portfolio

Platforms I Chose

In this task I set up and updated my profile on three platforms:

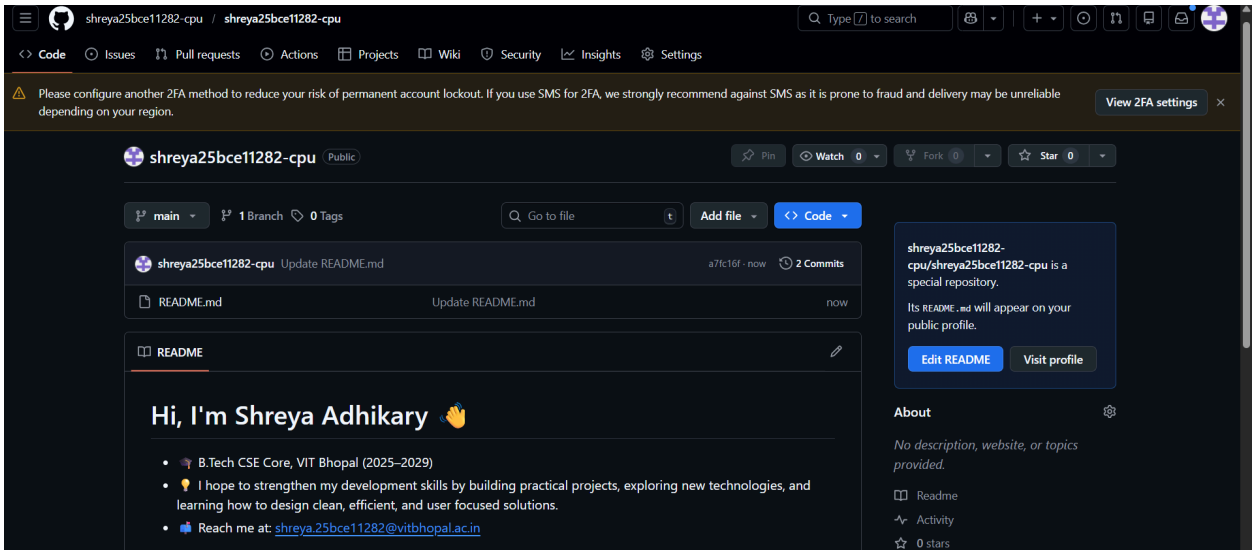
- ☐ GitHub
- ☐ LinkedIn
- ☐ Kaggle

Each of these platforms serve a very important purpose in a student's professional and academic journey.

Details about each platform and how I plan to use them over the next four years

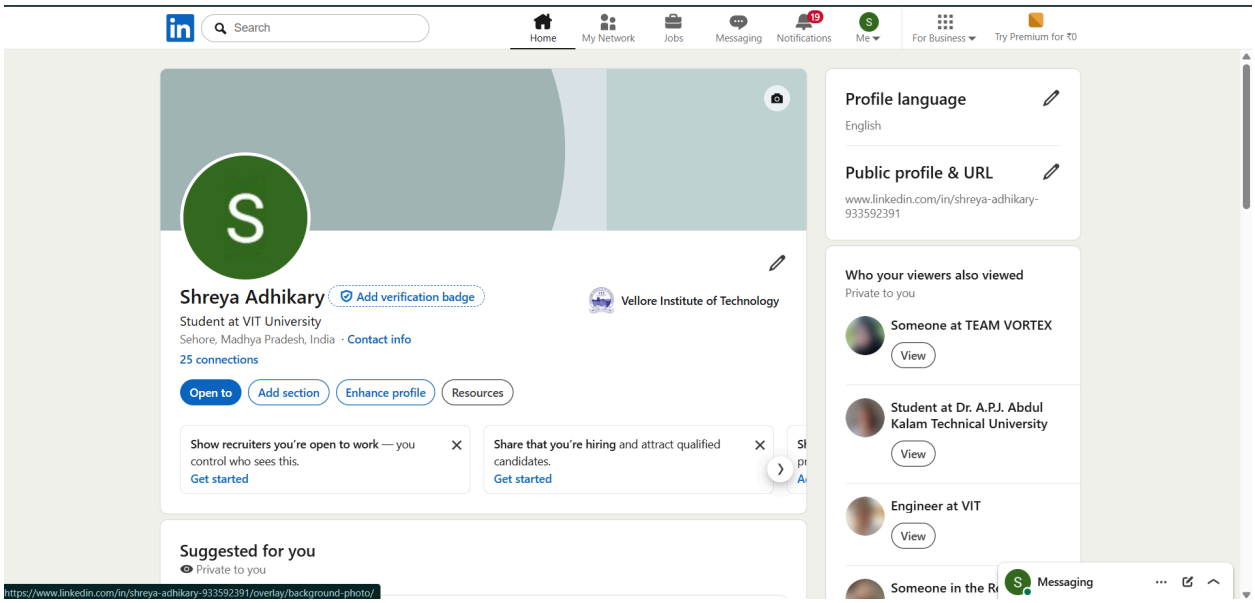
GitHub

GitHub is a platform used to store, manage, and share code and projects. As a computer science student, I plan to use GitHub to upload my assignments, personal projects, and internship work over the next four years so that anyone (including potential employers) can see my progress and growth as a developer.



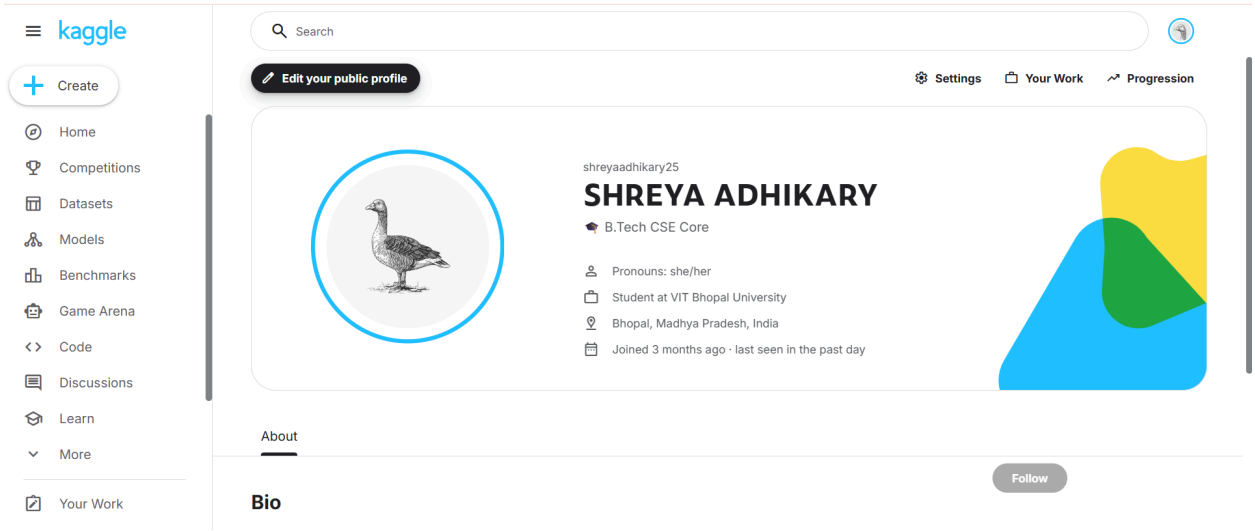
LinkedIn

LinkedIn is a professional networking platform used by students, working professionals, and recruiters worldwide. I updated my LinkedIn profile with my current education details at VIT Bhopal University. Over the next four years, I plan to use it to connect with seniors, apply for internships, and eventually for placements.



Kaggle

Kaggle is a platform focused on data science and machine learning, where students can participate in competitions, access free datasets, and take beginner-friendly courses. I created my profile on Kaggle as a starting point to explore data science, which is increasingly relevant across all branches of engineering.



Setting up these profiles made me realize that building a professional digital presence should begin from the first year itself, not just before placements

Task 3
Explore Coding & Collaboration Platforms

What platforms I used

In this task I worked with two categories of platforms :

- ☐ A coding practice platform (HackerRank)
- ☐ A cloud collaboration tool (Google Form Quiz)

Part A

For Part A, I used HackerRank, which is a platform where students can practice coding problems across different topics and difficulty levels. I completed three beginner level challenges and earned a badge in the process. The problems involved basic arithmetic operations and integer sequences using Python. This was my first experience solving structured coding problems online and it helped me understand how to read problem statements carefully and write clean, working code within constraints.

Part B

For Part B, I created a Google Form titled "Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz" with five questions including multiple choice and short answer questions. I linked the form responses to a Google Sheet so that answers can be collected and viewed automatically. Google Forms is a free tool that is part of Google

Workspace and is extremely useful for creating surveys, quizzes, and feedback forms without any technical knowledge.

The form is accessible here:
https://docs.google.com/forms/d/e/1FAIpQLSd_-xR6vpgGYaXgFyAyuq66UslN1EVtdvxVF2G4TRrFS8TYHQ/viewform

How these tools will help me academically

Both these tools will be very helpful academically. HackerRank for improving my coding skills before internships and placements, and Google Forms for collecting data, conducting peer surveys, and organizing group work during college projects.

Task 4
Professional Email & Etiquette Guide

Overview

For this task I wrote two professional emails and created a social media checklist. The first email was a request to a professor for an assignment extension, and the second was an expression of interest in a summer internship opportunity. Writing both emails taught me how tone, structure, and word choice completely change how a message is received. A poorly worded email can come across as rude or unprofessional even when that is not the intention.

One situation where poor digital communication caused a real problem

One situation where poor digital communication caused a real problem is when a student once posted a frustrated comment about their college publicly on social media after receiving a low grade. The post went viral within the campus community and reached faculty members, resulting in a formal warning and a damaged relationship with the department. Had the student addressed their concerns privately through email to the professor or academic counsellor, the issue could have been resolved without any negative consequences.

Task 5
Cybercrime Awareness Case Study & Prevention Guide

Introduction

For this task I researched phishing, one of the most common forms of cybercrime affecting college students in India. I wrote a detailed case study explaining what phishing is, how it works step by step, who is typically targeted, and what the consequences are. I also created a prevention checklist with ten actionable tips including two specific to UPI safety.

What surprised me the most during this task

What surprised me most during this task was how sophisticated phishing attacks have become. The fake websites used by attackers are often visually identical to the real ones, making it very difficult for an average user to tell the difference. I had assumed that only careless or uninformed people fall for such attacks, but the reality is that even educated individuals can be deceived.

One habit I will personally change as a result of this task

One habit I will personally change as a result of this task is to always type website URLs directly into the browser instead of clicking links in emails or messages, no matter how legitimate they appear.

Conclusion

This project gave me a well rounded introduction to the digital world as a first year engineering student. Across five tasks I learned how to create visual content, build a professional online presence, practice coding, communicate professionally through email, and protect myself from cybercrime. What stood out most was how interconnected these skills are. Being digitally literate is not one single skill but a combination of awareness, responsibility, and practical ability. The GitHub repository I have built through this project will serve as the foundation of my digital portfolio for the next four years.

References

- Canva – www.canva.com
- GitHub – www.github.com
- LinkedIn – www.linkedin.com
- Kaggle – www.kaggle.com
- HackerRank – www.hackerrank.com
- Google Forms – forms.google.com
- National Cyber Crime Portal – www.cybercrime.gov.in
- CERT-In Advisories – www.cert-in.org.in